

KEY BRAND ELEMENTS



HOW-TO GUIDE

Key Brand Elements



Successful branding, or re-branding, requires that key stakeholders are involved in a democratic process to agree on what the new brand will be. However, working with every stakeholder throughout the process is simply impossible.

Read this brief guide to learn how you can achieve consensus on your brand.



Use Demand Metric's **Branding Selection Tool** to help you provide choices for your stakeholders that are equally satisfactory for the brand champion.

What are the Key Branding Drivers?

- **Mergers and Acquisitions** — combining two distinctly different brands is perhaps the most difficult of all re-branding exercises.
- **Entering New Markets** — when new businesses are formed, or when old business units are spun off, organizations typically create new brands.
- **Updating Corporate Image** — organizations that have been in business for over 20 years often have a requirement to get their brand up with the times.

What Key Choices Need to Be Made?

- **Mission Statement** — your mission statement describes the fundamental reason you are in business. For example: to help our customers succeed.
 - **Vision Statement** — this is how you envision your organization and would like others to view you. Typically, vision statements look to the future.
 - **Corporate Values** — these are the core values that your organization believes in, i.e. Excellence, Continuous Improvement, and Community etc.
 - **Positioning Statement** — this aspect of your brand positions your product/service, or company, correctly within the industry.
 - **Corporate Tagline** — normally a very punchy 3–6 word sentence(s) that drives home your core messages. Be careful not to make this too generic.
 - **Logo** — corporate logos are images that identify your organization.
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Bottom Line

Effective branding requires input from all your key stakeholders. Work to understand your organizational roadmap, build a branding team, open the floor to suggestions, and achieve consensus on your brand.



Action Plan

STEP 1 - Understand Business Strategy

1

Understand Business Strategy



Develop a Balanced Scorecard Strategy Map

2

Build a Small Team

3

Gather Feedback

4

Narrow Down Options

5

Make Branding Selections

6

Implement Branding Strategy

- Speak with senior management to get a clear picture of where your organization is headed.
- It is impossible to develop a brand when there is no strategic direction.
- Use Demand Metric's **Branding Selection Tool** to provide your stakeholders with clear options for branding decisions

DEMAND METRIC			Learning & Growth Perspective
Objective 1 - Develop Employee Training Programs			
Programs, Initiatives, & Actions	Key Performance Indicators & Metrics	Target Timelines to Achieve Goals	
Skills & Training	# Staff Trained	80% of staff trained by end of year	
Quality Assurance	Average Customer Service Call QA Score	3.5 Average QA Score by Oct	
New Employee Onboarding & Communications	# Staff Certified	90 Staff Certified by Jan	
Objective 2 - Create Career Paths for Each Function			
Programs, Initiatives, & Actions	Key Performance Indicators & Metrics	Target Timelines to Achieve Goals	
Recruitment Management	Recruitment Success Management Plan	Plan completed by Jan	
Job Descriptions	Job Descriptions Completed	Completed by Jan	
Performance Reviews	Performance Review Metrics	Add business KPIs to all reviews by Oct	
Objective 3 - Launch Corporate Intranet			
Programs, Initiatives, & Actions	Key Performance Indicators & Metrics	Target Timelines to Achieve Goals	

Balanced Scorecard Strategy Map



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Action Plan

STEP 2 - Build a Small Team

1

Understand
Business
Strategy

2

**Build a
Small Team**



3

Gather
Feedback

4

Narrow Down
Options

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Selections

6

Implement
Branding
Strategy

Use the Brand Selection Tool for Branding Exercises

- Branding exercises can be implemented more efficiently if you have stakeholders engaged each step of the way.
- Build a cross-functional team of 3–6 key executives that can represent each of your brand constituencies, including customers.
- Use Demand Metric's **Branding Selection Tool** to provide your stakeholders with 3–4 clear options for branding decisions.



Branding Selection Tool



[VIEW RESOURCE](#)



Action Plan

STEP 3 - Gather Feedback

1

Understand
Business
Strategy

2

Build a
Small Team

3

**Gather
Feedback**



4

Narrow Down
Options

5

Make Branding
Selections

6

Implement
Branding
Strategy

Access and Leverage the Brand Perception Survey

- Poll customers and employees to identify how you are currently perceived in the market, and compare this to how you'd like to be seen.
- Additionally, ask for suggestions related to your branding choices.

The screenshot shows a two-page survey titled 'Brand Perception Survey'. The first page has a 'Purpose' section and a question about current perception. The second page has a question about desired perception and a list of branding elements to rate.

Brand Perception Survey





Action Plan

STEP 4 - Narrow Down Options

1

Understand
Business
Strategy

2

Build a
Small Team

3

Gather
Feedback

4

**Narrow
Down
Options**



5

Make Branding
Selections

6

Implement
Branding
Strategy

Discover the Winning Ideas for Your Brand

- Take all the given ideas and further develop them until you have 3–4 options for each brand category that would satisfy Marketing & senior management.
- Go back to your general audience with these options and vote for the winners.



Branding Selection Tool



[VIEW RESOURCE](#)



Action Plan

STEP 5 - Make Branding Selections

1

Understand
Business
Strategy

2

Build a
Small Team

3

Gather
Feedback

4

Narrow Down
Options

5

**Make
Branding
Selections**



6

Implement
Branding
Strategy

Tally Your Results and Determine Best Options

- Use Demand Metric's **Branding Selection Tool** to reference the different options, tally up the results and re-vote if necessary.



Branding Selection Tool





Action Plan

STEP 6 - Implement Branding Strategy

1

Understand
Business
Strategy

2

Build a
Small Team

3

Gather
Feedback

4

Narrow Down
Options

5

Make Branding
Selections

6

Implement
Branding
Strategy



Showcase Your New Identity Using a Brand Strategy Plan

- Now that you have your brand elements selected, develop and implement your branding strategy.
- This could include updating collateral & the corporate website, changing policies & procedures to accommodate your new identity, and communicating to customers.

Brand Strategy Scorecard		
Objective 1: Increased Employee and Customer Commitment to Branding from Senior Management		
Programs, Initiatives, & Actions	Key Performance Indicators & Metrics	Target Timeline to Achieve Goals
Developing Branding Programs	Budget Approved and Cost of Brand Commitment	Increase Branding Budget by 15%
Key Note Speaking Engagements	# of Conferences Attended & Speaking Engagements	Key Note Sales at 4 Conferences
Employee Branding Values Training Staff	# Internal Brand Promotion Sources Completed	Collect Surveys from all Employees by Q3
Objective 2: Address Commitment to Brand Values from Customer Facing Staff		
Programs, Initiatives, & Actions	Key Performance Indicators & Metrics	Target Timeline to Achieve Goals
Marketing Collateral & Presentations	Update all Documents and Presentations	Complete Checkpoint by end of Q2
Sales Scripting	Sales Staff use New Brand Messaging	85% staff using correct messaging by end of Q3
Customer Service Training	Customer Service Quality Assurance results	Increase CSAT Metrics by 15% by end of Q4
Objective 3: Increase Awareness of Brand Attributes and Differentiators among Key Media Sources		
Programs, Initiatives, & Actions	Key Performance Indicators & Metrics	Target Timeline to Achieve Goals

Brand Strategy Scorecard





Demand Metric helps Marketing teams get stuff done with practical tools, training, and a simple, modern platform for managing work.

Our analysts identify best practices from fast-growing companies and build Playbooks & Toolkits, Guides & Reports, Training Courses, and Project Templates to help you optimize your processes, add structure to your department, and get your team punching above their weight class.

Manage your work visually with our easy-to-use platform, built for small marketing teams by design. See what your team is working on at a glance so you can spend less time managing projects and more time knocking stuff off your list.

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